

**18 Days**

This retelling of the Mahabharat by Graphic India has sci-fi elements and consists of short episodes. <https://digit.in/jan20-03>

**Holy Cow Entertainment**

Check out Ravanayan, Aghori and other comics by Holy Cow Entertainment on their official site. <https://digit.in/jan20-04>

COMICS AND MYTHOLOGY

Most Indian comics are based on mythology or history

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Raj Comics began publishing superhero comics in 1984, with Doga, Nagraj and Bediya being the earliest characters in the genre. Around the same time, Raj Comics also started publishing issues based on Indian mythology, focused on mythological figures such as Bhishma, Ravan and Balram. Some of the early comics had original stories set in early history, or medieval times. Most of the comics have only been available in Hindi, with Nagraj being a notable exception. Amar Chitra Katha has an expansive collection of comics based on Indian mythology, with 73 issues. Within it are stories from Ramayan and Mahabharat, as well as stories focused around individual characters such as Kubera, Prahlada and Surya. Amar Chitra Katha also has a number of comics based on historical figures ranging across all time periods, including Mirabai, Tansen, and Jim Corbett. Together, Raj Comics and Amar Chitra Katha dominated the comic book scene for decades in India. However, there are a new bunch of publishers coming up now.

Graphic India has published Grant Morrison's 18 days, Myths of India and Ramayan 3392 AD. The last of these is set in the future, but is a retelling of Ramayana to showcase the fact

that the story is eternally relevant. Holy Cow Entertainment has Ravanayan, which tells the story from the perspective of the villain. Vimanika Comics has Dashaavatar, I am Kalki, Shiva and Durga. Campfire has a vast catalogue of historical and mythological graphic novels, including Chanakya: Of Serpents and Kings, The Kaurava

Aayumi Productions has Kaal, which is set in the underworld and features characters from mythology such as Garuda and Bhairav.

The allure of mythological and historical comics is easy to understand. Buyers can instantly understand what the comic is about, and are probably familiar with the story. They are also



A panel from Grant Morrison's 18 Days by Graphic India, showing the Pandava forces.

Empire and Sundarkaand: Triumph of Hanuman. Campfire does not restrict itself to only Indian mythology, and has graphic novels based on other mythologies as well, including Jason and the Argonauts, Zeus and the Rise of the Olympians, Legend: The Labours of Heracles and Perseus: Destiny's Call.

easy to market. However, despite the setting, these publishers can experiment and push boundaries. Some of these comics are decidedly for adults, and explore mature themes. Additionally, they might tell the story from fresh perspectives, or include characters that are not clearly good